



Edible olives

There are many varieties of olives—black and green, large and small. Most are used for making oil, but some are eaten whole, too. Raw olives are very bitter, but once they have been treated, fermented, and pickled, they taste delicious!



The trees are shaken to make the olives fall. Sometimes, machines are used to do this job.

Each long, flexible branch has lots of flowers and about 30 clusters of fruit.

Nets are laid down so that the fallen fruit can be gathered easily.

Surprising sources

Oil can be produced from lots of very different fruits and seeds.



Groundnuts
(Peanuts)



Cottonseeds



Sesame seeds



Rapeseed



Soybeans

Sunflower oil

Every sunflower is made up of hundreds of tiny flowers, surrounded by a fringe of petals. It is the seeds of the flowers that are rich in oil. Sunflowers are ready for harvesting when the flowers are dead and the heads have dried out. Sunflower oil is good for cooking oil, salad oil, and for making margarine.

